DAVID SARPONG

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

BSc student at Rhodes University majoring in Statistics, Mathematics and Information Systems, entering third year in 2027. Interested in data analytics, statistical modelling, risk and quantitative finance. Hands-on experience in Python, Pandas, R, SQL and MATLAB through two data analytics internships and independent projects, backed by peer mentoring, residence leadership and first-team university hockey.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, R, SQL, MATLAB, HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript

Libraries & Frameworks: Pandas, Matplotlib, Seaborn, SciPy, SymPy, React (Vite), Tailwind CSS

Databases: SQL querying (joins, subqueries, aggregation), database normalisation (1NF to BCNF)

Tools & Platforms: Microsoft Excel, RStudio, Anaconda, Google Colab, Git/GitHub

Analytics & Statistics: Data cleaning, exploratory data analysis, data visualisation, statistical simulation, probability and statistical modelling, statistical inference

EDUCATION

BSc Statistics, Mathematics and Information Systems — Rhodes University

2025 – 2027 (expected) | Makhanda, Eastern Cape

- Relevant Modules: Mathematical Statistics, Linear Algebra, Ordinary Differential Equations, Advanced Calculus, Abstract Algebra, Database Systems (SQL), Programming (Python), Information Systems

National Senior Certificate (Bachelor Pass) — Queen's College Boys' High School

2019 – 2023 | Queenstown, Eastern Cape

- Highlights: School Monitor, Academic & Leadership Full Scrolls (2021), debating, Think Tank, Eco Watch, Queen’s Quote magazine

PROJECTS

Statistical Simulation & Central Limit Theorem Analysis — R

July – August 2026 | Tech Stack: R

- Built a statistical simulation framework in R, modelling random samples drawn from an F-distribution
- Investigated empirical convergence and the Central Limit Theorem across different sample sizes
- Produced probability density plots and statistical summary reports

Customer Churn Predictive Analytics Pipeline — Data Analytics

June – July 2026

- Built an end-to-end data analytics pipeline analysing customer churn and support-ticket metrics
- Worked with raw data to identify insights relevant to customer retention

Personal Portfolio Website — Web Development

2026 | Tech Stack: React (Vite), Tailwind CSS, JavaScript

- Designed and built two versions of a personal portfolio site: a CV-style version and a narrative version

EXPERIENCE

Data Analytics Intern — Future Interns

May 2026 – Present

- Clean and analyse datasets using Python and Pandas, with close attention to data quality and accuracy
- Build visualisations and explore workflow automation to support the interpretation of data

Data Analytics Intern — Codveda

July – August 2026 | Remote

- Completed a remote internship with practical data analytics tasks and skills development

Peer Mentor and Tutor — Rhodes University

January 2026 – Present | Makhanda, Eastern Cape

- Support students with academic development and their transition to university life, building trust through consistency and reliability
- Explain concepts clearly, adapting communication to each student's needs

Residence Student Assistant — Rhodes University

January – February 2026 | Makhanda, Eastern Cape

- Provided front-line support to conference guests, handling queries, check-ins and accommodation logistics, and worked with residence staff to resolve day-to-day issues

Grade 11 Tutor — Private Tutoring

- Delivered structured academic support to high-school learners and explained concepts clearly

CERTIFICATIONS & CONTINUOUS LEARNING

- Statistics Onramp — MathWorks (2026)
- MATLAB Onramp — MathWorks (2026)
- Data Science & Analytics Internship Credential — Future Interns (2026)
- HTML5 Development Fundamentals — Mzansi Digital Learning (2026)
- Microsoft Ikamva Digital: AI Basics; Essentials in Cybersecurity — Microsoft (2026)
- Claude Academy: AI Fluency – Framework & Foundations; Claude Code 101 — Anthropic (2026)
- FNB App Academy (2026) and FlyRank AI Fluency Programme — participation

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

International Representative — Botha House, Rhodes University

January 2026 – Present

- Represent international students' interests within the residence, supporting communication, guidance and engagement
- Help build an inclusive community serving students from diverse backgrounds

Referee Liaison Committee Member — Rhodes University Hockey Club

- Coordinate referee availability and allocation for men's and women's fixtures so matches are staffed and run smoothly

First Team Hockey Player (Midfielder) — Rhodes University

- Compete at USSA and high-performance university level while balancing sport and a demanding degree through discipline and time management

Other Activities

- JSE Investment Challenge (2026): participated in an investment challenge focused on financial markets and investment decisions
- West African Society, Rhodes University: member contributing to cultural exchange and student community engagement

AWARDS, ACHIEVEMENTS & LANGUAGES

- Most Valuable Member — Botha House, Rhodes University (September 2026)
- Rhodes Hockey Bursary — Rhodes University (February 2026)
- Letter of Recommendation for Internship Performance — Future Interns (June 2026)
- World Scholar's Cup — Regional Round 2019 (first place, Junior debate team); Global Round qualifier 2020, Top 50 team with 9 gold, 4 silver and 3 bronze medals combined

Spoken Languages: English (native/bilingual), Twi (native/bilingual), isiXhosa (limited working proficiency)